



Dinornis

die-NOR-niss

- **When** 2 million–200 years ago (Neogene)
- **Fossil location** New Zealand
- **Habitat** Plains
- **Height** 12 ft (4 m)
- **Diet** Plants

Twice the height of a man, *Dinornis* (also called the giant moa) was the tallest flightless bird that ever lived. Flocks of *Dinornis* lived in New Zealand until humans settled on the islands about 700 years ago and hunted them to extinction. *Dinornis* belonged to the same bird family (ratites) as the emu, ostrich, and kiwi.



Argentavis

AR-jen-TAY-viss

- **When** 6 million years ago (Neogene)
- **Fossil location** Argentina
- **Habitat** Inland and mountainous areas
- **Wingspan** 26 ft (8 m)
- **Diet** Meat

Enormous wings



Argentavis was the largest bird that ever flew, with a wingspan more than twice that of today's record holder, the wandering albatross. As heavy as a man, it used its vast wings to catch rising air currents and so keep its body aloft, gliding effortlessly as it scanned the landscape for food. Some experts think *Argentavis* was a hunter that could swoop down and snatch prey. Others think it scavenged like a vulture.



Presbyornis

PREZ-bee-OR-niss

- **When** 62–55 million years ago (Paleogene)
- **Fossil location** N. America, S. America, Europe
- **Habitat** Lake shores
- **Height** 3 ft (1 m)
- **Diet** Plankton, water plants

Presbyornis looked like a tall duck. Large numbers of fossils, as well as eggs and nests, have been found in sites in North America that were once shallow lakes. Perhaps *Presbyornis* lived in huge flocks by the shore, the birds wading into the shallows to feed, using their beaks to filter food from the water, as ducks do. *Presbyornis* was one of the most successful birds of its time, living for millions of years.

Ducklike beak

